

0.1 The Rebuke of Mara

1. Thus, was heard by me. At one time, the venerable Mahamoggallana was dwelling among the Bhaggas at the Sumsumaragira Bhesakala Grove, the Deer Park. At that time the venerable Mahamoggallana was walking up and down in the open air.

2. At that time Mara, the Evil One, having entered the venerable Mahamoggallana's stomach, went into his intestines. Then this occurred to the venerable Mahamoggallana: Why is my stomach so heavy? It is as if I am pregnant, I think. So then, the venerable Mahamoggallana having descended from his walking path, having entered his dwelling, sat down on a prepared seat. Having sat down, the venerable Mahamoggallana attended to the root source internally.

3. The venerable Mahamoggallana saw that Mara, the Evil One, having entered his stomach, had gone into his intestines. Having seen Mara, the Evil One, he said this: "Come out, O Evil One. Come out, O Evil One. Do not harass the Tathagata. Do not harass the Tathāgata's disciples. Let this not lead to your harm and suffering for a long time."

4. So then, this occurred to Mara, the Evil One: "This samana surely does not know me. He does not see me when he says thus: "Come out, O Evil One. Come out,

O Evil One. Do not harass the Tathagata. Do not harass the Tathāgata's disciples. Let this not lead to your harm and suffering for a long time." Even the Teacher would not know me so quickly, so how could this disciple know me?"

5. Then the venerable Mahamoggallana said this to Mara, the Evil One: "In regard to this I know, O Evil One. Do not think I do not know. You are Mara, the Evil One. It occurred to you thus: "This samana surely does not know me. He does not see me when he says thus: "Come out, O Evil One. Come out, O Evil One. Do not harass the Tathagata. Do not harass the Tathāgata's disciples. Let this not lead to your harm and suffering for a long time." Even the Teacher would not know me so quickly, so how could this disciple know me?""

6. So then, it occurred to Mara, the Evil One: "This samana surely does know me. He does see me when he says thus: "Come out, O Evil One. Come out, O Evil One. Do not harass the Tathagata. Do not harass the Tathāgata's disciples. Let this not lead to your harm and suffering for a long time." Even the Teacher would not know me so quickly, so how could this disciple know me?" Then, Mara, the Evil One, having come out of the venerable Mahamoggallāna's mouth, rising up, stood against the door bolt.

7. The venerable Mahamoggallana saw Mara, the Evil One standing still against the door bolt. Having seen, he said this to Mara, the Evil One. Here too I see you, O Evil One. Do not think: “He does not see me.” This is you, O Evil One, standing against the door bolt.

8. In the past, O Evil One, I was a mara named Dusi. My sister was named Kali. You were my sister’s son, so you were my nephew. At that time, O Evil One, the Auspicious One Kakusandha, the Arahant, the rightly self-awakened one, had arisen in the world. The Auspicious One Kakusandha, the Arahant, the rightly self-awakened one, O Evil One, had a pair of disciples named Vidhura and Sanjiva, the foremost auspicious pair. Among all of the disciples of the Auspicious One Kakusandha, the Arahant, the rightly self-awakened one, O Evil One, there were certainly not any of them who could match the venerable Vidhura in this case, namely the exposition of the Dhamma. In this way, O Evil One, by this method, the venerable Vidhura came to have the designation Vidhura.

8. But the venerable Sanjiva, O Evil One, either gone to the forest, gone to the root of a tree, or gone to an empty hut, without trouble or difficulty, would attain to the cessation of perception and feeling. Once upon a time, O Evil One, the venerable Sanjiva having sat under the root of a certain tree, entered upon the cessation of perception and feeling. The cowherds, shepherds, farmers, and

passersby, O Evil One, saw the venerable Sanjiva seated under the root of a certain tree having entered upon the cessation of perception and feeling. Having seen, this occurred to them: “It is marvellous indeed, Sir. It is unprecedented indeed, Sir. This samana has passed away sitting just here. Well now, let’s cremate him.” So then, O Evil One, those cowherds, shepherds, farmers, and passersby, having collected grass, pieces of wood and cowdung, having heaped them up over the venerable Sanjiva’s body, having set it on fire, they departed. Then, O Evil One, when the night had passed, the venerable Sanjiva, having emerged from that attainment, having shaken out his robes, having dressed in the morning, having taken his bowl and outer robe, entered the village for alms food. Those cowherds, shepherds, farmers, and passersby, having seen the venerable Sanjiva wandering in search of alms food, this occurred to them: “It is marvellous indeed, Sir. It is unprecedented indeed, Sir. This samana passed away just sitting down. Now this person has come back to life.” In this way, O Evil One, by this method, the venerable Sanjiva came to have the designation Sanjiva.

9. Now, O Evil One, this occurred to the Mara Dusi: “These bhikkhus who are virtuous in conduct, pleasant in habits, I just don’t know their coming or going. What if I were to take possession of the brahmins and house holders and say: “Come, all of you, revile, abuse, annoy and harass the bhikkhus who are virtuous in conduct,

pleasant in habits. Hopefully while you are reviling, abusing, annoying and harassing the bhikkhus who are virtuous in conduct, pleasant in habits, there might be some alteration in their mind, whereby Mara Dusi might gain an opening.”” So then, O Evil One, Mara Dusi took possession of the brahmins and house holders and said: “Come, all of you. Revile, abuse, annoy and harass the bhikkhus who are virtuous in conduct, pleasant in habits. Hopefully while you are reviling, abusing, annoying and harassing the bhikkhus who are virtuous in conduct, pleasant in habits, there might be some alteration in their mind, whereby Mara Dusi might gain an opening.””

10. Then, O Evil One, those brahmins and house holders, being possessed by Mara Dusi, reviled, abused, annoyed and harassed the bhikkhus who were virtuous in conduct, pleasant in habits thus: “But these bald-headed samana wannabes, dark out-castes, offsprings of our kinsmen’s feet, claim: “We are meditators, we are meditators.” Then in a drunken stupor with sagging shoulders and drooping heads, they meditate, in a daze, with a gaze, unfazed. Indeed just as an owl on a tree branch looking out for a mouse meditates, in a daze, with a gaze, unfazed, so too these bald-headed samana wannabes, dark out-castes, offsprings of our kinsmen’s feet, claim: “We are meditators, we are meditators.” Then in a drunken stupor with sagging shoulders and drooping heads, they meditate, in a daze, with a gaze, unfazed. Indeed just as a jackal on a river bank looking out for a

fish meditates, in a daze, with a gaze, unfazed, so too these bald-headed samana wannabes, dark out-castes, offsprings of our kinsmen's feet, claim: "We are meditators, we are meditators." Then in a drunken stupor with sagging shoulders and drooping heads, they meditate, in a daze, with a gaze, unfazed. Indeed just as a cat on a rubbish heap looking out for a mouse meditates, in a daze, with a gaze, unfazed, so too these bald-headed samana wannabes, dark out-castes, offsprings of our kinsmen's feet, claim: "We are meditators, we are meditators." Then in a drunken stupor with sagging shoulders and drooping heads, they meditate, in a daze, with a gaze, unfazed. Indeed just as an unladen donkey on a rubbish heap meditates, in a daze, with a gaze, unfazed, so too these bald-headed samana wannabes, dark out-castes, offsprings of our kinsmen's feet, claim: "We are meditators, we are meditators." Then in a drunken stupor with sagging shoulders and drooping heads, they meditate, in a daze, with a gaze, unfazed." Now at that time, O Evil One, the majority of those humans, with the breakup of the body, after death, mostly arose in the lower worlds, unhappy destination, the woeful plane, hell.

11. Then, O Evil One, the Auspicious One Kakusandha, the Arahant, the rightly self-awakened one, addressed the bhikkhus: "The brahmins and house holders, O bhikkhus, have been possessed by Mara Dusi, saying: "Come, all of you. Revile, abuse, annoy and harass the bhikkhus who are virtuous in conduct, pleasant in habits. Hopefully

while you are reviling, abusing, annoying and harassing the bhikkhus who are virtuous in conduct, pleasant in habits, there might be some alteration in their mind, whereby Mara Dusi might gain an opening.” Come, O bhikkhus. With a mind imbued with metta, dwell pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world, dwell pervading with a mind imbued with metta, abundant, exalted, immeasurable, free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with compassion, dwell pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world, dwell pervading with a mind imbued with compassion, abundant, grown great, immeasurable, free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with mudita, dwell pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world, dwell pervading with a mind imbued with mudita, abundant, grown great, immeasurable, free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with equanimity, dwell pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world, dwell pervading with a mind imbued with equanimity, abundant, grown great, immeasurable, free from enmity and ill-will.”

12. Then, O Evil One, those bhikkhus being advised and instructed by the Auspicious One Kakusandha, the Arahant, the rightly self-awakened one thus, gone to the forest, also gone to the root of a tree, also gone to an empty hut, dwelled with a mind imbued with metta, pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world they dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with metta, abundant, exalted, immeasurable, free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with compassion, they dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world they dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with compassion, abundant, exalted, immeasurable, free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with mudita, they dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world they dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with mudita, abundant, exalted, immeasurable, free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with equanimity, they dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world they dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with equanimity, abundant, exalted, immeasurable, free from enmity and ill-will.

13. Then, O Evil One, this occurred to the Mara Dusi: “Even though I am doing thus, these bhikkhus who are virtuous in conduct, pleasant in habits, I neither know their coming nor their going. What if I were to take possession of the brahmins and house holders and say: “Come, all of you, honor, esteem, respect and worship the bhikkhus who are virtuous in conduct, pleasant in habits. Hopefully while you are honoring, esteeming, respecting and worshiping the bhikkhus who are virtuous in conduct, pleasant in habits, there might be some alteration in their mind, whereby Mara Dusi might gain an opening.”” So then, O Evil One, Mara Dusi took possession of the brahmins and house holders and said: “Come, all of you. Honor, esteem, respect and worship the bhikkhus who are virtuous in conduct, pleasant in habits. Hopefully while you are honoring, esteeming, respecting and worshiping, the bhikkhus who are virtuous in conduct, pleasant in habits, there might be some alteration in their mind, whereby Mara Dusi might gain an opening.” Then, O Evil One, those brahmins and house holders, being possessed by Mara Dusi, honored, esteemed, respected and worshiped the bhikkhus who were virtuous in conduct, pleasant in habits. Now at that time, O Evil One, the majority of those humans, with the breakup of the body, after death, mostly arose in a happy destination, a heavenly world.

14. Then, O Evil One, the Auspicious One Kakusandha, the Arahant, the rightly self-awakened one, addressed the

bhikkhus: “The brahmins and house holders, O bhikkhus, have been possessed by Mara Dusi, saying: “Come, all of you. Honor, esteem, respect and worship the bhikkhus who are virtuous in conduct, pleasant in habits. Hopefully while you are honoring, esteeming, respecting and worshiping the bhikkhus who are virtuous in conduct, pleasant in habits, there might be some alteration in their mind, whereby Mara Dusi might gain an opening.” Come, O bhikkhus. Dwell seeing in accordance with non-beauty, being percipient of repulsiveness in food, being percipient of non-delight in the whole world, seeing in accordance with impermanence in all saṅkhāras.”

15. Then, O Evil One, those bhikkhus being advised and instructed by the Auspicious One Kakusandha, the Arahant, the rightly self-awakened one thus, gone to the forest, also gone to the root of a tree, also gone to an empty hut, dwelled seeing in accordance with non-beauty, being percipient of repulsiveness in food, being percipient of non-delight in the whole world, seeing in accordance with impermanence in all saṅkhāras.

16. Then one morning, O Evil One, the Auspicious One Kakusandha, the Arahant, the rightly self-awakened one, having dress, having taken bowl and outer robe, entered the village for alms food with the venerable Vidhura as his attendant. So then, O Evil One, Mara Dusi having possessed a certain boy, having siezed a stone, gave a blow to the venerable Vidhura’s head and cut his head

open. So then, O Evil One, with his head cut with blood dripping, the venerable Vidhura just followed behind the Auspicious One Kakusandha, the Arahant, the rightly self-awakened one. Then, O Evil One, the Auspicious One Kakusandha, the Arahant, the rightly self-awakened one, having turned around his whole body, looked at Mara Dusi with the elephant look and said: "This Mara Dusi does not recognize his measure." And having looked with that elephant look, O Evil One, Mara Dusi fell away right there and arose in the great hell.

17. Now, O Evil One, there are three names for that great hell, the six domains for contact proper, the meeting together of iron stakes proper, to be experienced by oneself proper. So Then, O Evil One, the hell wardens having approached, said this: "Good man, when stake meet stake in your heart, then you would know that you have been roasting in hell for a thousand years." For many years, O Evil One, for many hundreds of years, for many thousands of years, for many hundreds of thousands of years, I roasted in that great hell. For ten thousand years I also roasted in the subsidiary of that great hell called, "Emergence from feeling." My body, O Evil One, was that of a human but my head was that of a fish.

What was the kind of hell,
where Dusi roasted;
for attacking the disciple Vidhura,
of the Brahmin Kakusandha.

Hundred iron spikes,
 all of them felt individually;
 such was the hell,
 where Dusi roasted;
 for attacking the disciple Vidhura,
 of the Brahmin Kakusandha.

O dark one, you will undergo suffering,
 for attacking such a bhikkhu;
 a disciple of the Buddha,
 the bhikkhu who knows this.

In the middle of the ocean stands,
 a palace lasting for an aeon;
 charming, the color of lapis lazuli,
 radiant, luminous;
 there celestial nymphs dance,
 of many diverse colors.

O dark one, you will undergo suffering,
 for attacking such a bhikkhu;
 a disciple of the Buddha,
 the bhikkhu who knows this.

Surely he who, exhorted to act by the Buddha,
 with the bhikkhu Sangha looking;
 shook with his big toe,
 Migāra's Mother's palace.

O dark one, you will undergo suffering,
for attacking such a bhikkhu;
a disciple of the Buddha,
the bhikkhu who knows this.

He who caused to shake,
the Vejayanta palace with his big toe;
supported by psychic powers,
shocking the devas.

O dark one, you will undergo suffering,
for attacking such a bhikkhu;
a disciple of the Buddha,
the bhikkhu who knows this.

He who at the Vejayanta palace,
interrogated Sakka;
do you know, O friend,
freedom by the extinction of thirsting;
of that Sakka answered truthfully,
the question that was asked.

O dark one, you will undergo suffering,
for attacking such a bhikkhu;
a disciple of the Buddha,
the bhikkhu who knows this.

He who interrogated that Brahma,
near the Sudhamma hall;
today, O friend, are you of the view,

the view which you formally held;
do you see the radiance,
surpassing the Brahma world?

Of that Brahma answered,
truthfully in sequence;
dear sir, I am not of that view,
the view which was formally held by me.

I do see the radiance,
surpassing the Brahma world;
so how could I say today,
that I am permanent and eternal.

O dark one, you will undergo suffering,
for attacking such a bhikkhu;
a disciple of the Buddha,
the bhikkhu who knows this.

He who by liberation ,
has touched the peak of Mount Meru;
visited the forests of Pabbavideha,
and the lands where other humans dwell.

O dark one, you will undergo suffering,
for attacking such a bhikkhu;
a disciple of the Buddha,
the bhikkhu who knows this.

Indeed the fire does not think,

“I will burn the fool.”;
but the fool who attacks,
a blazing fire gets burned.

So too you, O Mara,
attacking the Tathagata;
you only burn yourself,
just like the fool who touches fire.

O Mara, you have generated demerit,
attacking the Tathāgata;
Do you think, O Evil One,
my evil will not ripen?

You are heaping up evil,
for your long term lamentation;
give up on the Buddha, O Mara,
do not create aspiration in the bhikkhus.

“Mara thus alarmed,
by the bhikkhu at the Bhesakala Grove;
being dejected from that,
the spirit disappeared right there.”